

Adopt better strategy for ease of adoption

Even as India records its highest adoption numbers in over a **decade**, crossing 4,500 in 2024-25, the process remains slow. Demand far **outstrips** supply - over 35,500 waiting parents vs 2,400 available children. Two **legislations deal with** it: Hindu Adoptions and Maintenance Act 1956, and Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act 2000. Central Adoption Resource Authority (CARA) serves as both central and **nodal** authority for both domestic and international adoptions of Indian children. 2021 **amendments** to **Juvenile** Justice Act intended to **speed up** adoption by shifting authority from courts to DMs. But without clear timelines for pending cases, delays continue.

Another key issue is lack of children entering the formal adoption system. A 2022 parliamentary committee said this decline **signals** either a **thriving** illegal adoption market, or systemic failures in bringing **orphaned** or **abandoned** children into registered agencies. Many childcare homes remain unregulated and disconnected from adoption networks, **rendering** thousands of children invisible to **prospective** parents. Society's **attitude** towards adoption **adds to** the problem. **Many couples**, often in their late 40s-50s, **consider** it as a **last resort** after **exhausting** medical options. This urgency can push them toward illegal channels rather than **navigating** a **tedious** legal process.



While strict regulations protect child rights, the system needs urgent reform to balance **oversight** with efficiency. **Streamlining** case transfers, **setting** deadlines for adoption orders and **bringing** more childcare institutions under CARA's **ambit will** help. **Making** adoption a more accessible and **transparent** process **is** about **giving** thousands of children **a real shot** at having a happy, normal life.

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

[Practice Exercise]

Vocabulary

1. **Adoption** (noun) – child placement, fostering, legal parenthood, guardianship, taking in गोद लेना
2. **Decade** (noun) – Period of ten years, दशक
3. **Outstrip** (verb) – surpass, exceed, overtake, go beyond, outperform अधिक होना / पार कर जाना
4. **Legislation** (noun) – law, statute, act, regulation, legal framework कानून / विधि
5. **Deal with** (phrasal verb) – handle, manage, address, tackle, resolve निपटना
6. **Nodal** (adjective) – central, key, main, coordinating, focal प्रमुख / केन्द्रीय
7. **Amendment** (noun) – modification, revision, change, update, correction संशोधन
8. **Juvenile** (adjective) – youth-related, child, adolescent, minor, underage किशोर / बाल
9. **Speed up** (phrasal verb) – accelerate, hasten, quicken, fast-track, advance तेजी लाना
10. **Signal** (verb) – indicate, show, convey, suggest, point out संकेत देना
11. **Thriving** (adjective) – flourishing, growing, booming, prospering, successful फल-फूल रहा / समृद्ध
12. **Orphaned** (adjective) – parentless, abandoned, alone, unaccompanied, destitute अनाथ
13. **Abandoned** (adjective) – deserted, left, discarded, neglected, forsaken परित्यक्त
14. **Render** (verb) – make, cause, result in, lead to, bring about बनाना / कर देना
15. **Prospective** (adjective) – potential, possible, likely, hopeful, future संभावित
16. **Add to** (phrasal verb) – increase, escalate, contribute to, intensify, aggravate बढ़ाना
17. **Last resort** (phrase) – final option, ultimate choice, only remaining way, fallback, emergency measure अंतिम उपाय
18. **Exhaust** (verb) – use up, deplete, drain, consume, run out of समाप्त कर देना
19. **Navigate** (verb) – manage, handle, deal with, maneuver, work through रास्ता निकालना
20. **Tedious** (adjective) – boring, lengthy, monotonous, tiring, time-consuming थकाऊ / उबाऊ

21. **Oversight** (noun) – supervision, monitoring, control, regulation, management निगरानी / देखरेख

22. **Streamline** (verb) – simplify, optimize, organize, make efficient, standardize सुव्यवस्थित करना

23. **Ambit** (noun) – scope, range, domain, reach, jurisdiction क्षेत्र / दायरा

24. **Transparent** (adjective) – open, clear, accountable, visible, honest पारदर्शी

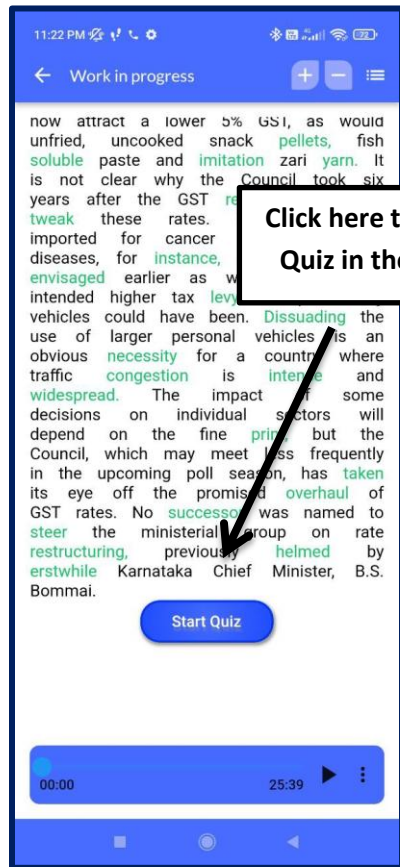
25. **Give a shot** (phrase) – try, attempt, give a chance, make an effort, take a go प्रयास करना

@mocks_wallah

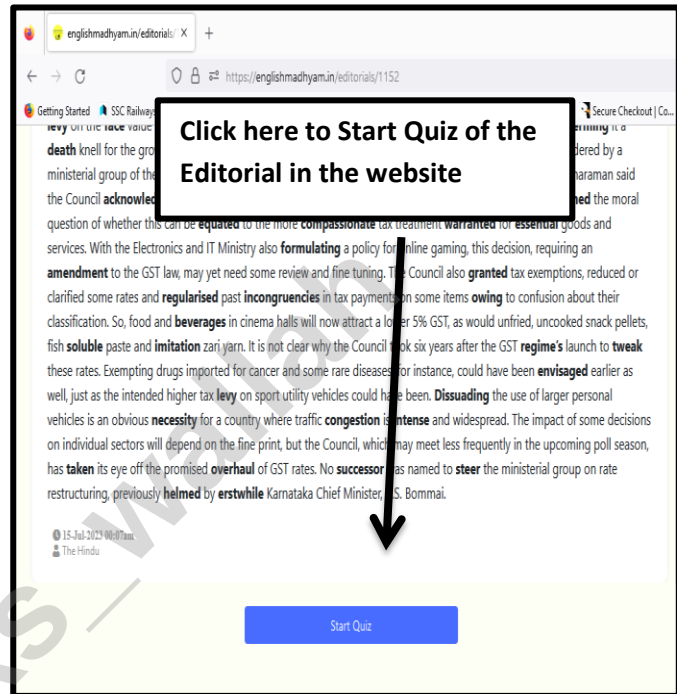
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Record Adoptions** – India saw over 4,500 adoptions in 2024-25, the highest in a decade.
2. **Demand-Supply Gap** – There are 35,500 waiting parents but only 2,400 children available for adoption.
3. **Legal Framework** – Two laws govern adoption: Hindu Adoptions and Maintenance Act (1956) and Juvenile Justice Act (2000).
4. **CARA's Role** – Central Adoption Resource Authority oversees both domestic and international adoptions.
5. **JJ Act Amendments** – The 2021 amendment shifted adoption powers from courts to District Magistrates to speed up the process.
6. **Persistent Delays** – Despite the legal shift, lack of case deadlines causes ongoing delays in adoption finalization.
7. **Child Availability Crisis** – Very few children enter the formal adoption pool.
8. **Parliamentary Concerns** – A 2022 committee warned this could signal illegal adoptions or failure to integrate abandoned/orphaned children into the system.
9. **Unregulated Homes** – Many childcare institutions are not linked with CARA, making many children invisible to the adoption system.
10. **Social Stigma** – Adoption is often viewed as a last resort, with many older couples turning to it only after failed fertility treatments.
11. **Illegal Market Risk** – This desperation can drive couples toward unregulated or illegal adoption channels.
12. **Need for Reform** – The current system, while protective of children, lacks efficiency and accessibility.
13. **Streamlining Needed** – Reforms should focus on faster case transfers and fixed timelines for adoption orders.
14. **Better Integration** – More childcare homes should be brought under CARA to widen the pool of adoptable children.
15. **Focus on the Child** – Ultimately, improving the adoption process is about giving children a chance at a stable, loving home.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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